🌻 Animated social map around Donald Trump

📅 23 Feb 2026

Data source and processing

Data source

This paper currently uses **Google News RSS search** (site-filtered by source domains) rather than CC-NEWS parsing.

- Data route: Google News RSS query endpoint (`news.google.com/rss/search`)
- Scope: US-English (`hl=en-US`, `gl=US`)
- Source control: fixed source-site allowlist in the collection script

Current date settings:

- Validation/default quick window: **January 2020 to February 2020**
- Full anchor window used for proportional sample sizing: **January 2020 to February 2026**

Current query-term list (US politics focus, no longer Trump-only):

`trump`, `covid`, `jobs`, `employment`, `economy`, `biden`, `vance`, `harris`, `maga`, `republican`, `democrat`, `gop`, `white-house`, `president`, `election`, `campaign`, `senate`, `house`, `congress`, `epstein`, `tariffs`, `doge`, `ice`, `immigration`, `deportation`, `border`, `politics`, `party`.

Collection now includes a strict post-retrieval check: a row is only kept if the assigned `query_term` appears in that row's title or snippet text.

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Processing pipeline

1. Build month-by-month RSS queries by term + source site + `after/before` date bounds.
2. Fetch RSS results with retry/backoff and paced requests.
3. Parse headline, link, date, source label, and short snippet from each item.
4. Keep only rows where the `query_term` is present in title/snippet text.
5. Deduplicate by URL and story key.
6. Convert publication date to UTC-like timestamp string.
7. Draw a month-balanced, source-balanced sample to `top_n`.

Target row count is proportional to the selected timespan when `--top-n` is not provided (anchored to 12,000 rows for Jan 2020 to Feb 2026).

Link identification for social map

From sampled text, links are coded using the same social-link logic described in :

- Nodes represent social actors (people, groups, institutions).
- Directed links represent actor-to-actor relationships (not abstract causal mechanisms).
- Relationship labels/tags are attached to each link.
- Sentiment and time labels are added where possible.

The resulting table is converted to app-compatible link columns (`Cause`, `Effect`, `Tags`, plus metadata) for mapping.

Animation method

Animation follows the Causal Map app's **Animate filter** behavior documented in `causal-map-extension/webapp/README.md`:

- Select one link field to define frames (for example month or another time field).
- Optional cumulative mode includes all earlier frames up to the current frame.

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- Frame construction respects pipeline order, so filter ordering affects what appears in each animation step.

Attribution note

Google News RSS is an aggregated discovery feed, not a publisher ranking API. Terms such as “top” in this workflow refer to **sampling rules in processing** (filters and balancing), not editorial prominence.

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